

dashboard, instrument cluster, steering wheel, layout of buttons, and the central console are all as usual.

What also remains more or less the same is its competition. The mid-size luxury SUV segment is one of the most popular ones among luxury car buyers in India, and the BMW X3's competitors include players like the Mercedes-Benz GLE Class, Audi Q5, Volvo XC60, Jaguar F-Pace and the relatively new Lexus NX300h. The BMW X3, hence, will face stiffer competition than ever before.

MAINSTREAM UTILITY: MAHINDRA XUV500

After numerous sightings and speculations, the 2018 Mahindra XUV500 has finally been rolled out officially, presenting a distinctly noticeable facelift along with upgrades to multiple elements about the car. The new XUV500 falls in a hotly contested segment of SUVs with the likes of the Jeep Compass and Tata Hexa, as well as more compact offerings like the Ford EcoSport and the Hyundai Creta eating into market shares of full-size SUVs.

Inside, the 2018 Mahindra XUV500 gets a 7-inch touchscreen display, which appeared slightly dim on default settings, and is set a bit too deep inside. While that helps prevent glares and direct sunlight incidence, reaching out to the display from the driver's position can be a bit of a bother. To compensate for that, there are a host of buttons on the gloss black centre console of the XUV500.

The setup includes Android Auto, although Apple CarPlay has still not been made available. But, you do get Mahindra's Connected Apps ecosystem, which includes apps like Gaana, Zomato, BookMyShow and other such services, which you can directly access from the infotainment display itself. Otherwise, it gets the standard Bluetooth connectivity for telephony, mobile connectivity and audio streaming. Debuting with the XUV500 is smartwatch connectivity, which can be used to control audio playback, handle navigation, track location and tyre pressures, and get door

ajar warnings via haptic feedback when the car is in motion. Unfortunately, there is no direct connectivity between the app and the infotainment system. This prevents active geofencing and location tracking on the new XUV500.

The buttons down the central console are made of plastic, and while they are backlit, the tactile feedback is shallow and tacky. Similar button feedback persists with the steering controls and the air conditioning unit, and while the overall quality of soft touch plastics on the dashboard and door inserts have been improved, these front console and button panels feel like a strange discord.



hold/descent control, a first-in-class automatic emergency contact dialing system, auto wipers and headlamps, tyre pressure monitoring system and reverse parking camera with dynamic guide rails. The exterior changes include the new, studded chrome grille, new design on projector headlamps and LED DRLs and new claddings for fog lamps. The tail gate now gets a new design, with more chrome and texturing, new wraparound LED tail lamps and faux skid plates with chrome-inlaid exhausts. The rear end also gets a spoiler lip, and optional 18-inch alloy wheels with a new design. There are two new



The XUV500 gets tan leather quilted seats with double stitching, which look quite upmarket. The driver's seat also gets six-way electronic adjustment, and both front and rear rows get central armrests. The third row of seats get their own air flow control and storage nets to the sides. For adults, anything more than short distances in the third row would end up being quite uncomfortable. The XUV500 also gets ambient LEDs in corners and a sunroof. With all seats up, the XUV500 barely gets any luggage space, which is a major con.

Safety-wise, the Mahindra XUV500 gets six airbags, ABS with EBD, ESP, hill

colours as well - Mystic Copper and Crimson Red.

The 2.2-litre, mHawk diesel engine is paired with a sixth generation electronic Variable Geometry Turbocharger (eVGT). The diesel engine now produces 155bhp and 360Nm torque, and is available with both the 6-speed manual and the 6-speed automatic gearboxes. The 2.2-litre, 4-cylinder mHawk turbo-charged petrol engine, meanwhile, remains in the same state of tune, producing 140bhp and 320Nm torque. The fuel tank has a maximum capacity of 70 litres, with the diesel engine bearing a rated fuel economy of 15.4kmpl. 